IOWN

The Morning Brief

APRIL 29, 2026

Catalyst Day

Tech leads a broad pullback into the FOMC and four Mag7 prints; energy and IOWN earnings dispersion define the tape.

S&P 500	NASDAQ COMP	TECH (XLK)	WTI (USO)	FEAR & GREED
~7,117 ↓0.49%	~24,664 ↓1.01%	$157.85 ↓1.69%	$139.60 ↑3.62%	26 · Fear

SECTION 01

Markets

RECORDS REVERSE ON TECH COMPRESSION — ENERGY CARRIES THE TAPE INTO THE FOMC AND MAG7 STACK

The S&P 500 surrendered Monday's record close, falling 0.49% to roughly 7,117 while the Nasdaq Composite dropped 1.01% and the Russell 2000 declined 1.17%. The pullback was concentrated in technology, where XLK fell 1.69% as the AI-infrastructure complex came in for sustained de-risking ahead of tonight's hyperscaler prints. Energy was the clear leader at +1.66% as USO rallied 3.62% and BNO advanced 2.76% on the Iran-Hormuz standoff, while staples (+0.90%), real estate (+0.97%) and utilities (+0.13%) also held green. The tape is communicating a coordinated rotation out of multiple-driven AI exposure into the cash-flow and defensive sleeves, with Carson's SPY support at $645.80 still well below current trading and unchallenged. UVXY compressed 3.20% even as breadth deteriorated — positioning is leaning into the Wednesday catalyst stack rather than hedging it.

IOWN EARNINGS DISPERSION — PCAR FALLS 5.97% ON THE MISS, EIX BEATS BUT FADES, NXPI BEAT SELLS OFF

Five IOWN names reported Tuesday, and the price action diverged from the headline numbers. PCAR missed at $1.15 versus consensus $1.17, with the stock falling 5.97% to $119.61 as investors parsed muted Class 8 backlog commentary against an in-line revenue print. EIX delivered a beat at $1.42 versus $1.33 expected and reaffirmed full-year guidance of $5.90-$6.20, but the stock retraced 0.92% to $67.94 as Morgan Stanley trimmed its utility outlook. NXPI beat at $3.05 versus $3.01 with automotive revenue up 6% year-over-year and Industrial & IoT up 24%, yet the shares fell 2.74% to $230.39 alongside the broader semi sleeve compression. OKE posted EPS of $1.30 against $1.32 estimates but the headline 12% net income growth and 13% adjusted EBITDA increase took shares 2.32% higher to $89.79. HOOD missed materially at $0.38 versus $0.43 with crypto revenue down 47% year-over-year — the stock fell 2.24% to $82.07.

WEDNESDAY'S STACK — FOMC AT 2:00 PM ET, THEN FOUR MAG7 PRINTS DEFINE THE AI-CAPEX RESET

The FOMC delivers its decision today at 2:00 PM ET with the Powell press conference at 2:30 PM. CME FedWatch implies a hold with effectively no probability of a move, with the target range expected to remain at 3.50%-3.75% per Polymarket consensus near 100%. The market-relevant content will be the press-conference language on energy-inflation pass-through and any framing of the Powell-to-Warsh succession ahead of the May 15 term expiry. After close, MSFT, GOOGL, META, and AMZN report sequentially — the four collectively account for an estimated $600B-$645B in 2026 AI capital expenditure per CreditSights and

Yahoo Finance compilations. The hyperscaler capex commentary is the principal cross-current that will determine whether the Tuesday compression in NVDA (−1.59%), AMD (−3.41%), TSM (−3.12%), MRVL (−3.15%), and CRDO (−8.08%) extends or reverses. Three IOWN names also report today: GD, QCOM, and ADP — QCOM after close is the most consequential for the dividend sleeve.

S&P 500	~7,117 · ↓0.49% · Off Monday's record
TECH / ENERGY	XLK ↓1.69% · XLE ↑1.66% · Clear rotation
IOWN REPORTS TODAY	GD pre · QCOM after close · ADP
MAG7 TONIGHT	MSFT · GOOGL · META · AMZN after close
FOMC	2:00 PM ET · Hold priced · Powell penultimate
CARSON'S ACTIVE LEVEL	SPY $645.80 support · Untested · Set Apr 13

A tape that compresses tech 1.7% and rallies energy 1.7% on the same session, into a stack that contains the FOMC, four hyperscaler prints, and Q1 GDP/PCE in 24 hours, has already begun the rotation Wednesday's catalysts will define. **Research Reveals Opportunities.**

SECTION 02

Geopolitics

TRUMP REJECTS THE HORMUZ-FIRST FRAMEWORK — UAE REPORTEDLY EXITS OPEC+ THIS WEEK

The Iranian proposal that reached the White House Monday — reopen the Strait of Hormuz and end the war in exchange for the lifting of the US naval blockade, with nuclear talks deferred — received a public rejection from Secretary Rubio Tuesday, with President Trump expressing dissatisfaction to advisors per CBS News, Al Jazeera, and CNBC reporting. The structural impasse hardens: Iran insists the blockade lift before substantive nuclear talks, and the US insists any framework must address enrichment alongside the maritime de-escalation. CNN reporting from Day 60 of the conflict indicates the UAE will exit OPEC and OPEC+ this week, a development that would meaningfully reorder the supply-coordination architecture if confirmed. Energy flows through Hormuz remain effectively halted, with roughly 20 million barrels per day of crude, fuels, and petrochemicals affected per IEA characterization — the largest energy supply shock on record. The Panama Canal is now seeing a notable spike in vessel traffic per Reuters as global shipping reroutes around the Middle East disruption.

OIL APPROACHES $100 WTI — REFINING AND MIDSTREAM HOLD THE IOWN ENERGY THESIS

USO closed up 3.62% Tuesday and BNO advanced 2.76% as the diplomatic track collapsed, with WTI futures pushing toward $100 per barrel and Brent near $111 per CNBC and Al Jazeera coverage. The IOWN energy sleeve participated cleanly: CTRA led at +2.85% to $34.63, OKE added 2.32% to $89.79 alongside its earnings reaction, CVX rallied 1.94% to $188.36, and VLO advanced 0.85% to $240.27. CNX gained 1.69% on the natural gas-adjacent bid. Reuters and CNBC both indicated EPD's CEO warned the market is underestimating the duration of the Hormuz disruption, while Shell's CEO publicly stated energy shortages may extend into next year. BP's reported Q1 profit doubling to $3.2B per Reuters provides concrete evidence of the integrated-energy monetization thesis. Refining margins remain materially above pre-conflict levels per Morgan Stanley research. Gold compressed 1.86% and silver fell 3.12% as risk capital rotated toward duration-sensitive equity and energy — an unusual cross-current at this stage of the conflict.

IRAN PROPOSAL	Rejected · Rubio — nuclear deferral unacceptable
UAE / OPEC+	Reportedly exiting this week · Per CNN
OIL	USO ↑3.62% · BNO ↑2.76% · WTI ~$100
ENERGY LEADERS	CTRA ↑2.85% · OKE ↑2.32% · CVX ↑1.94%
GOLD / SILVER	GLD ↓1.86% · SLV ↓3.12%
CONFLICT DAY COUNT	Day 60 · Hormuz flows — 20 mb/d affected (IEA)

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Four Mag7 prints tonight will define whether the AI-tape multiple holds or compresses further. MSFT (consensus near $4.04 EPS on $81.4B revenue per Yahoo Finance), GOOGL (~$2.64 EPS on $92.2B revenue), META, and AMZN report sequentially after close. The four collectively guide an estimated $600B-$645B in 2026 capital expenditure per CreditSights, with Meta's $115B-$135B range, Alphabet's $175B-$185B, and Amazon's ~$200B the principal anchors. Tuesday's 1.7% XLK compression, with NVDA at –1.59%, AMD at –3.41%, TSM at –3.12%, MRVL at –3.15%, KEYS at –2.45%, and CRDO at –8.08%, indicates positioning has begun to de-risk into the print. Microsoft's last-quarter capex hit $29.88B, up 89% year-over-year per investor compilations — any deceleration in stated guidance would extend the rotation; an upside surprise could re-rate the entire IOWN growth sleeve. *Think Like an Owner.*

2. QCOM reports tonight after close — AI-edge optionality versus the modem-insourcing thesis. Consensus sits near $2.61 EPS on revenue of $10.59B per Yahoo Finance and Meyka, with the SeekingAlpha Q2 preview framing AI optionality and the reported OpenAI-MediaTek custom-chip collaboration as the central narrative. The stock closed Tuesday at $150.00, having traded a $7.50 intraday range. The Barclays Underweight thesis ($130 target) and JPMorgan Hold ($140 target) anchor the counter-positioning, citing Apple modem-insourcing risk and a 2027 royalty cliff. Recent prior-quarter reads show QCOM beat by $0.11 in the February print. GD also reports today and ADP both pre-market — GD is positioned for read-across on the Trump defense plan that drew rare Republican pushback per Yahoo Finance; ADP's payroll commentary will frame the labor backdrop ahead of Friday's consumer spending angle. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

3. Q1 advance GDP and March Personal Income & Outlays both print Thursday at 8:30 AM ET. The BEA release schedule confirms April 30, 2026 for both the Q1 GDP advance estimate and the March Personal Income and Outlays release, which contains the March PCE data. The PCE component is the more market-relevant data point given the energy-driven inflation backdrop. March CPI ran at 3.3% year-over-year per recent BLS data, with oil prices the principal driver. An accelerating core PCE would harden the Fed's hold posture into June and reinforce the higher-for-longer commodity-inflation thesis underlying the energy sleeve. JPMorgan Research and Morgan Stanley both sit at hold-through-2026 on the rate path. The release is consequential for the long end and the duration-sensitive sub-sleeves: TLT closed Tuesday at $86.37 (+0.10%). *Simplicity Over Complexity.*

4. PCAR's 5.97% drop and EIX's muted reaction frame the dispersion question. PCAR missed by $0.02 and lost roughly $7.59 per share Tuesday despite revenue and parts-segment strength — the print signals the Class 8 truck cycle has not yet inflected, with industrial end-markets carrying more weight than the headline suggests. EIX delivered a clean beat and reaffirmed guidance, yet the Morgan Stanley utility downgrade kept shares roughly flat. The dispersion has implications for IOWN's broader reporting calendar: CAT (which closed –1.32% Tuesday) and STLD (+0.85%) carry the read-across to the industrial complex, while ATO, NEE (+1.77%), and BKH absorb the regulated-utility framing. NXPI's automotive-up-6% and Industrial & IoT-up-24% commentary is constructive for ADI, TEL (–2.49%), and the analog complex despite the Tuesday tape. *Avoid Erosion.*

5. The digital-asset sleeve held in relative to a risk-off equity tape. IBIT closed Tuesday at $43.27 (–0.67%) and ETHA at $17.37 (+0.58%) — a notably contained drawdown given the broader 1% Nasdaq decline, with ether ETF actually finishing green. Bitcoin spot traded near $76,500 Tuesday morning per Yahoo Finance. The HOOD print confirmed crypto trading revenue dropped 47% year-over-year, validating the structural-flow thesis that ETF ownership is increasingly displacing direct exchange volume. BlackRock announced a fresh crypto partnership per Benzinga, and the Saylor 11.5% yield financing structure continues to attract institutional capital. The HUT, MARA, and CRDO crossover thesis with AI-power infrastructure remains the cleanest digital-physical IOWN linkage, though all three sold off Tuesday on broader semi-complex pressure. *The physical world matters.*

6. The Panama Canal traffic spike and UAE-OPEC reporting are early signals of supply-chain re-routing. Reuters reporting Tuesday flagged a notable jump in Panama Canal vessel traffic as shippers reroute around Middle East disruption — a quantifiable read on the duration premium being baked into trade flows. CNN's Day 60 coverage indicating the UAE will exit OPEC and OPEC+ this week, if confirmed, would materially alter Gulf supply coordination and could intensify the bid for VLO, CVX, CTRA, and OKE. The IEA continues to characterize the disruption as the largest energy supply shock on record. A weekend escalation event — tanker seizure, kinetic action, or formal talks collapse — would gap oil higher and pressure the AI-tape multiple ahead of Friday's month-end rebalance flows. The pair-trade between energy beneficiaries and rate-sensitive growth remains the principal portfolio cross-current. **Think Like an Owner.**

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